## Conclusion

The cost of the 1948 Arab-Israeli War was enormous. Many of Israel's most productive agricultural areas were destroyed, the war cost an estimated $500 million in direct expenditure on arms and supplies, and almost 6,500 Israelis were killed, representing nearly 1% of the total population in 1948. Still, Israel not only survived the attack by four Arab armies, but it was able to prevent the advance of all of them and to end the war occupying more territory than it would have done under the proposed UN partition agreement. The IDF had proved itself in combat and quickly became one of the most respected military organizations in the world. In Israel, this war is remembered as the War of Independence and is commemorated every year by Yom Ha'atzmaut, a national day on May 14.

In the Arab world, the war is often referred to as the Nakba ("Catastrophe"), and May 15 each year is marked by the Palestinian people as Nakba Day. Unsurprisingly, there are three entirely different narratives of this war produced by Israeli, Arab, and Palestinian historians. In Israel, for many years, the war was celebrated as a triumph for the nascent State of Israel, where it achieved a notable military victory despite the IDF being outnumbered by the armies of its Arab neighbors. There is certainly some truth to this view.

Simply creating a modern nation-state is complex and challenging enough, but doing so during a large-scale war seems to be a virtually impossible task. In the first weeks of the war, the newly formed IDF was certainly poorly equipped, especially in terms of tanks, aircraft, and artillery, and its forces were much smaller than those of the Arab armies it faced. Yet by the time of the end of the first truce, on July 8, large-scale immigration brought many more troops to the IDF so that it had achieved something close to parity with the attackers. Continuing clandestine arms deliveries, especially from Czechoslovakia, provided the IDF with the arms it needed and even with its first combat aircraft. The ability of the new IDF to withstand the combined invasion by the armies of four Arab nations was certainly remarkable, and up to the mid-1980s, this was the focus of most works by Israeli historians.

In 1987, the publication of two books by Israeli historians (*The Birth of Israel: Myths and Realities* by Simha Flapan and *The Birth*